

KARA RIPPE

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Undergraduate student combining psychology and data science to pursue Human-Computer Interaction and Engineering Psychology. Aiming to use R/Python and experimental design to improve user performance in fast-paced, information-heavy digital environments.

EDUCATION

University of Kansas | Lawrence, KS

Bachelor of Arts in Psychology | GPA: 3.96 | Expected May 2027

- Minor: Classical Antiquity | Certificate: Interdisciplinary Data Science
 - Honors: Dean's List (2023–Present), Academic Honors Scholarship
 - Relevant Coursework: Research Methods in Psychology, Foundations of Data Science (R), Data 1: Dealing with Data (Python), Moral Issues in Computer Technology (Technology Ethics), Introduction to Behavioral Research Methods in Communication
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RESEARCH & INTERACTION DESIGN PROJECTS

Cognitively Optimized Heads-Up Display — Independent Project

Interaction Designer | *Fall 2025–Spring 2026*

- Constructed a low-fidelity Head-Up Display (HUD) conceptual design tailored for time-compressed, 3D simulated environments
- Repositioned vital resource indicators (health/mana bars) to the upper visual periphery to diminish cognitive workload during high-stress tasks
- Designed a centralized lock-on mechanic paired with context-sensitive UI elements that automatically decay during passive exploration to prevent visual masking

Nexus Mods Front-Page Usability Redesign — Independent Project

UX Researcher & Interface Designer | *Fall 2025–Spring 2026*

- Collected qualitative user data about the Nexus Mods' website from community forums to establish design requirements for a Figma redesign, focusing on visual architecture attuned to returning users
- Restructured the main dashboard from dense vertical arrays into easily scannable horizontal grids to prioritize immediate access to favored games, file uploading, and personalized mod selection
- Applied visual ergonomics principles by adjusting typography weight and luminance contrast across the signature orange/grey color palette to reduce visual fatigue

Analysis of Aerospace Mission Dynamics — The University of Kansas

Quantitative Researcher & Data Analyst | *Spring 2026*

- Collaborated with a 4-person research team to evaluate a 4,324-row global aerospace launch dataset (1957–2022)
- Cleaned, wrangled, and transformed raw international data using R to calculate historical launch failure and success rates across individual countries
- Programmed data visualizations and time-series trendlines in ggplot2 to present increasing aerospace mission dependability through system reliability and mission coordination

Player Engagement & Media Tropes — The University of Kansas

Quantitative Researcher & Data Analyst | *Spring 2026*

- Analyzed *Backlogg'd* user data within a 4-person research team to compare player logging behaviors and lasting development trends, companies, and title success across roughly forty years of game releases (1980–2023)
- Situated findings within broader media trope patterns to examine company and video game success across genres, allowing useful insight into what components players found most meaningful
- Translated these findings into presentable custom tables (*gt*), combined trendlines (*patchwork*), and a dumbbell plot to communicate user preferences

TECHNICAL & METHODOLOGICAL SKILLS

- Languages & Software: R (tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr), Python (Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), Foundational HTML/ SS
- Tools: Figma, RStudio, Excel, Google Colab, Git/GitHub
- Research Methodology: Cognitive Workload Optimization, Usability Evaluation, Information Architecture, Hypothesis Testing, Inferential Statistics, Data Cleaning

